Federalism Dynamics: Enhancing Policy Efficacy through Development, Administration, and Delivery Strategies

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Public policy implementations in federations have involved clashes and concepts. Developing an idea for policy is even though the first and initial step, but when it comes to delivery of the policy, it must have a successful and effective implementation. Throughout history, we have seen how policies have been implemented, how responsive they were, and how those policies were amended and executed. With changing geopolitics and the emergence of new forms of governance, political power has been distributed between territories, states, and local governments, and each affects how policies will be designed and implemented successfully. Therefore, it is said that “Success in implementing public policies in federations requires a mixture of strategies ranging from coercion to collaboration and cooperation." [1]

In this paper, I will examine that, despite the "implementation barriers" like opposition from key stakeholders, overlapping roles of Government in the implementation and administration of a policy - lack of clarity on operations, roles, and responsibilities, how Federalism contributes to effective-delivery of public services and what are the drawbacks that Federalism has, that if controlled or eliminated would lead to more public focused ideas and contribute more to the society and benefit a large section of key stakeholders.

[1] Wiltshire, Kenneth. "Federalism and Policy Implementation." *Oxford Research Encyclopaedia of Politics*. 2020.

For this paper, I will define *Federalism* as "A political system in which government power and responsibility is divided between the federal legislature and state or provincial legislatures."[2] After researching a lot, I have arrived at the conclusion that Federalism contributes to the effective development, administration, and delivery of public services. The multi-level accountability structure that allows the presence of Government closer to the people, inter-governmental collaborations, and restructured leadership focuses on policy development that is based on innovation and pragmatic approaches. Therefore, Federalism allows for some room for policy experimentation despite the increased cost of governance and overlapping roles between different levels of Government.

Canada has a representative form of democracy with a federal structure of Government. Just like representation is key for development and progress, democracy is a form of Government that is of the people, by the people, and of the people, which means the more representation and say of the people, the healthier and stronger the democracy and its policies. Public policy success demands and support have been crucial in the national development under Federalism.[3]

The distribution of power and authority between territories and different levels of Government affects the design of policies and the chance that they can be implemented throughout the nation.

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[2] McIntosh, Andrew, and Garth Stevenson. *Federalism in Canada*. https://www.thecanadianencyclopedia.ca/en/article/federalism. Accessed 10 Feb. 2023.

[3] Dunn, Christopher, editor. *Provinces: Canadian Provincial Politics, Second Edition*. 3rd ed., University of Toronto Press, 2008. *JSTOR*, http://www.jstor.org/stable/10.3138/j.ctt2ttwhj . Accessed 10 Feb. 2023.

The distribution of power and authority between territories and different levels of Government affects the design of policies and the chance that they can be implemented throughout the nation. One of the most pertinent aspects of Federalism is that it allows that it allows the presence of Government closer to the people, which induces a sense of connectedness with the Government of the day through multi-level governance.[4] The presence of local government bodies like mayors, councillors, members of the Legislative Assembly (MLA), and the provincial Government allows for effective communication and administration, which leads to strong foundational bases for development at the grassroots levels. If the power is centred only at the central Government and there are no representatives at the local level, this allows for power and political concentration at the federal level, thereby making the people farther from the voices of the people and harder for the voices to be heard and also quite possible that the leaders at the centre would hear their needs and objectives.[5]

Not only this, but it may also result in the formulation and implementation of policies that may be unpopular and impractical, thereby bringing in a sense of alienation of people towards the Government. Within the Canadian regime, increasing attention has been paid to both vertical (multi-level) and horizontal (among various organs of the Government) aspects of governance.[6]

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[4] Hill, Carey. *Two models of multi-level governance, one model of multi-level accountability: drinking water protection in Canada and the United States*. Diss. University of British Columbia, 2006.

[5] Blair, George S. *The Journal of Politics*, vol. 50, no. 2, 1988, pp. 530–32. *JSTOR*, https://doi.org/10.2307/2131811 . Accessed 10 Feb. 2023.

[6] Papillon, M. 'Nation to Nation? Canadian Federalism and Indigenous Multi-Level Governance'. *Canadian Federalism: Performances, Effectiveness, and Legitimacy*, 2020, pp. 395–426.

This multi-level focus on accountability allows a sense of connectedness between people and the governments, and in turn, it is the Government's responsibility to lay down policies that positively affect the people. By presenting effective means of asking the Government to account and, at the same time, enhancing the effectiveness of the Government, Federalism has proven to resolve the key issue of making sure that the Government is not far from people through the means of accountability and influence at the state, local and the federal level. This allows citizens to possess democratic powers, delegate their needs from the local to the Federal Government, and feel that they are also a part of the system.

The delivery of public policy has been made possible through Federalism. This comes when both levels of Government, both at the federal and provincial levels, can collaborate with each other, and they undertake policy initiatives that aim at safeguarding the needs of citizens. This collaboration ensures that public policies are based on their respective capacities and power. This collaboration between different levels of Government allows for no absolute dominance of a single party that makes the decisions for the entire nation. Federalism also makes sure that there is a broadening of the power-sharing base in the nation. This collaboration ensures that there is power sharing between different levels of the Government and that there is an equal representation of their respective constituents. This distribution allows proper consent of the interest groups and the key stakeholders to be taken at the local level and then subsequently taken forward to the provincial and national levels. In this "collaborative federalism," there is the

generation of autonomy of power where the exercise of partial self-governance through state and national governing bodies.[7]

Through collaboration and multi-level accountability, Federalism has delivered effective public policies and restructured leadership that focuses on policy development based on pragmatic and innovative approaches. Federalism has allowed the development of policies that have been able to cater to their own needs and satisfy requirements. Federalism as a system has given some authority for regional and smaller groups to have policy development without going through the long process of federal government intervention, which means states and local communities have some authority to cater to local demands. Federalism offers multiple access points to find solutions for problems that we are struggling with and that relate to pragmatic and innovative approaches in the way of the easy leadership structure at each level of Government. This not only gives space for policy experimentation for states to develop policies to help the people without having any national consensus and agreement from other states, as each state knows what the demands are and what the possible steps could be undertaken to bring solutions for the people.

[7] Cameron, David and Simeon, Richard. "13. Intergovernmental Relations in Canada: The Emergence of Collaborative Federalism (2002". *The Daily Plebiscite: Federalism, Nationalism, and Canada*, edited by Robert Vipond, Toronto: University of Toronto Press, 2021, pp. 178-198. https://doi.org/10.3138/9781487533717-017

In Canada, a key policy that has been developed because of collaboration, multi-level accountability, and restructured leadership is the Medicare system, also known as Universal Health Coverage (UHC). Medicare refers to Canada's publicly funded healthcare system.[8] This program is administered by the provincial and territorial governments under the national standards as legislated and enforced by the Federal Government. Medicare is funded and financed by the Government of Canada and the other 13 provincial and territorial programs to provide full coverage for Medicare services.[9] This program has seen success because of its development, where the provincial and the territorial Governments would pay the bills and simultaneously follow the preservation of portability of coverage for Canadians within the nation.[10] Even though the success has been more limited when measuring it on a federal level, provincial and territorial governance plays a key role in administering and successfully executing the program. [11]The Medicare system, which has been developed under Federalism, would have been difficult to develop and witness such success in any other form of governance. Even though the federal form of governance is in most of the nation, such execution can only be possible through mutual trust, collaborations, and Canada's accountability structure. This tells us that Federalism may sometimes help in policy experimentation because the Federal Government failed to have a UHC coverage after World War 2, and the provincial governments had the idea

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[8] Seenandan-Sookdeo, Kendra-Ann I. "The influence of power in the Canadian healthcare system." *Clinical Nurse Specialist* 26.2 (2012): 107-112.

[9] Marchildon, Gregory. 'Canadian Medicare as a Policy Success'. *Policy Success in Canada*, Oxford University Press Oxford, 2022, pp. 17–35, https://doi.org10.1093/oso/9780192897046.003.0002.

[10] Gregory, *Canadian Medicare as a Policy Success*, 21

[11] Torrance, George M. "Socio-historical overview: The development of the Canadian health system." *Health and Canadian society: Sociological perspectives,* (1998): 3-22.

and legal powers to achieve such ideas. Therefore, equal accountability and power-sharing based on Federalism sometimes allow for successful policy implantation where each level of Government gets to learn from each other.

However, even though Federalism contributes to the effective development and implementation of policies, this governance system also has some disadvantages. Federalism contributes to the identical and conflicting policies that emerged from different levels of Government and sometimes results in overlapping roles and duplication of responsibilities. This leads to confusion among key stakeholders on whom to account for and ask questions. Furthermore, Federalism sometimes contributes to mistrust and misguidance among voters on whom to trust, and people need clarification about the information that the policy initiator or developer presents.

Although the power is divided among each level of Government, the overlapping roles of different levels of Government lead to unforeseen effects on other policy implementations. As a result, there are hindrances on each level of Government to fulfilling the promises and obligations that they have laid for the successful implementation and success of policy goals, which may be interrupted by the actions of other governmental levels.[12] It can create a challenge for the citizens to comprehend who is ultimately responsible and which government level to hold

[12] Bache, Ian, and Matthew Flinders. 'Multi-Level Governance and the Study of the British State'. *Public Policy and Administration*, vol. 19, no. 1, SAGE Publications, Jan. 2004, pp. 31–51, https://doi.org10.1177/095207670401900103.

accountable. Sometimes, these conflicts between state and federal governments hinder the path of national development.

Another consequence of Federalism is that there are additional operating costs of governance. Having multiple levels of Government requires high maintenance costs, and this may be difficult for many nations to bear the expense of multiple officers, wages, and members. Therefore, these extra expenditures may result in less public-focused policy development but pay for maintenance of these offices. This ideological rigidity sometimes drifts in when there are different political parties in power as each tries to demonstrate that the ideas have originated in their party and, therefore, the credit and accountability should lie with their political party, implying that the politically and ideologically sensitive approaches fail to achieve the national interest but focus on a specific state or community.[13]

Therefore, Federalism contributes to the effective development and delivery of public policy. It brings the Government closer to the people and infuses a sense of belongingness between the Canadian population and the Government. Federalism governance has helped Canada develop and build effective policies for the nation's development and, at the same time, help develop diverse populations at each level of Government. In conclusion, despite the fact that Federalism has few disadvantages that hinder national accountability and development, whenever it comes

[13] Leo, Christopher, and Jeremy Enns. "Multi-level governance and ideological rigidity: The failure of deep federalism." *Canadian Journal of Political Science/Revue Canadienne de science politique* 42.1 (2009): 93-116.

to policy formulations, formulations and administration, Federalism has always played a central role in the national development of public policies.

Ultimately, a country can enjoy the maximum output of its policies, where there is more deliberation over each policy, and the people have a sense of trust and connectedness with every level of Government.

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